STUDY 02

Notes on Reversible Systems

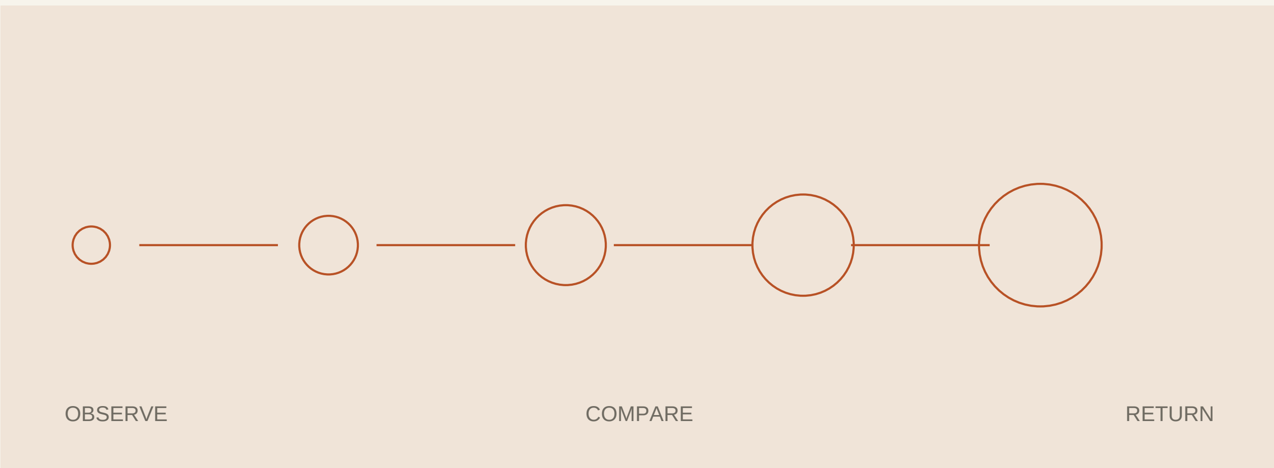
An operational sketch for systems that can be inspected, changed and restored without losing their history.

02

01

State before action

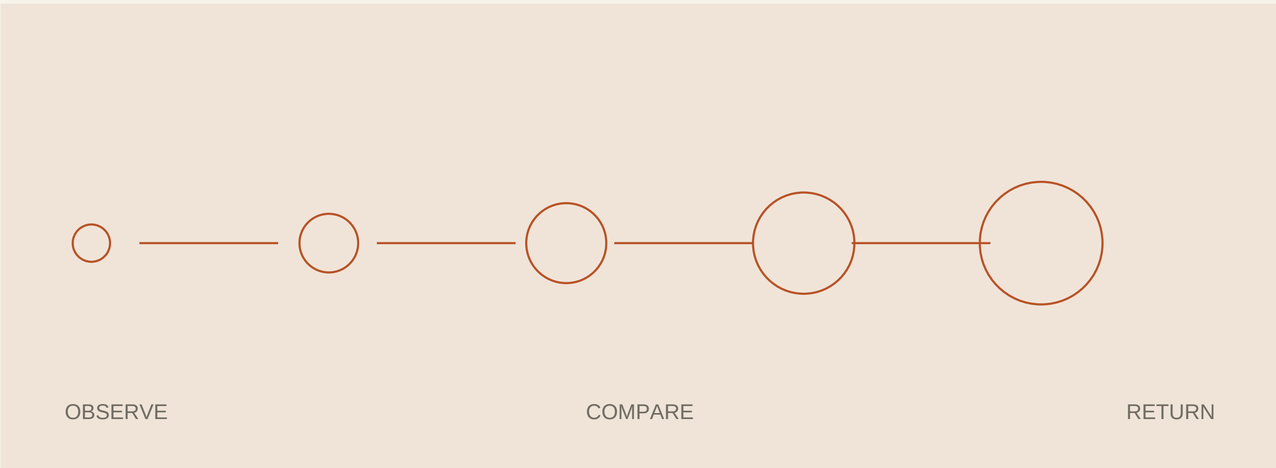
A reversible system makes its current state legible before it permits mutation. The operator should know what will change, which records will be affected, and what artifact will be available if the action fails.



02

Backups are arguments

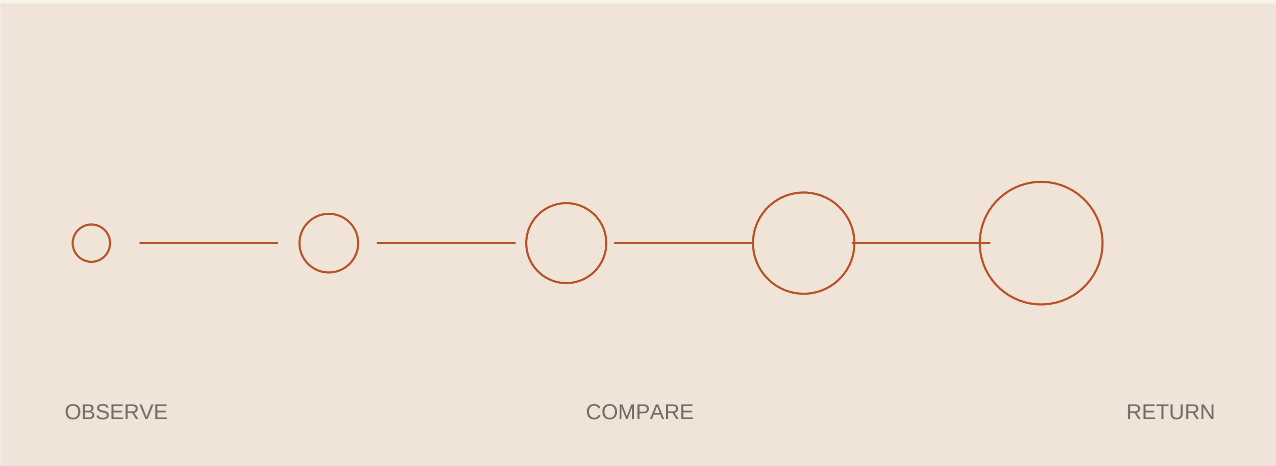
A backup is not proof of recovery. It is only a claim until a clean system can read it, verify it and restore the intended logical state. The recovery procedure is part of the data format, not an appendix written after deployment.



03

Bound every queue

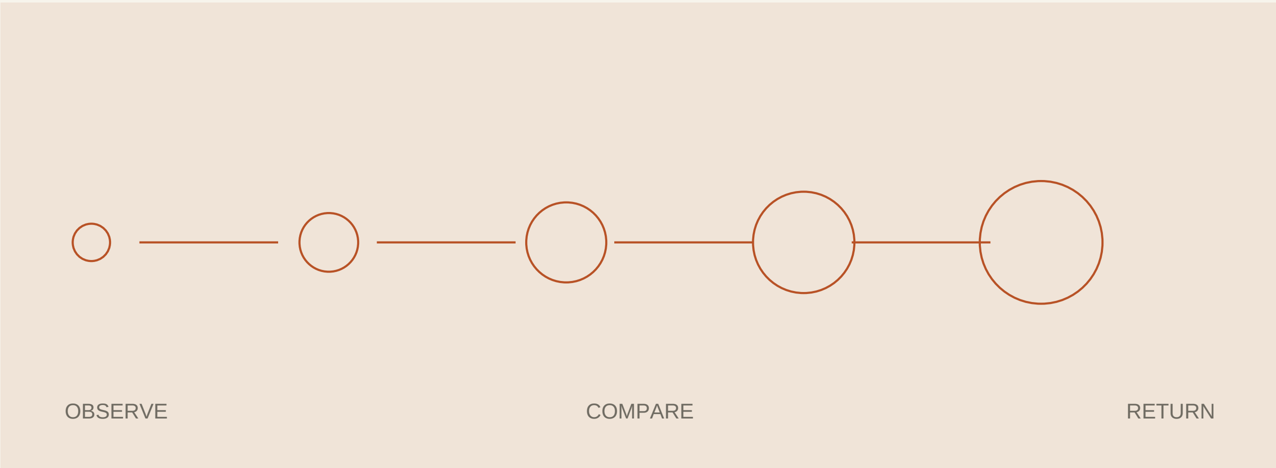
Jobs, logs and temporary artifacts need limits by count, age and size. A system that accumulates evidence without a retention rule eventually loses the ability to explain itself under pressure.



04

Health is a contract

A process that started is not necessarily a service that recovered. Success belongs to the health contract: the required state is readable, the critical route responds, and the service can perform the operation that justified the update.



> Reversibility is a design property. It appears when state, evidence, limits and recovery are visible in the same system.

END OF FIELD NOTE

LABORATORY / 2026